Year 4 English | The Unexpected Visitor

Learn and notice | Use dialogue to change what happens

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention

I can use dialogue to reveal useful information and move a story forward.

Learn from this example

Luca heard a knock at the classroom door. A woman stood outside, holding a muddy backpack.

“Does this belong to your class?” she asked.
“That is our excursion bag,” Luca said. “Where did you find it?”

“Beside the oval gate. There is a note inside.”
Luca opened the front pocket. The note listed the equipment they needed for tomorrow. He called the teacher before anything else could be lost.

Writing detective

1. What new information does the visitor give?
2. Which question leads to a useful answer?
3. What action follows the conversation?

Notice and explain

A. “Hi.” “Hello.” “How are you?”
B. “The gate is locked,” Ava said. “Try the side entrance,” replied Ben.
Which exchange gives a character a next action?

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Think and plan | Use dialogue to change what happens

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Your writing task

Write The Unexpected Visitor for classmates. Use a short conversation that changes what a character knows or does. Finish the story; do not write only a conversation.

Character and setting

Who is there before the visitor arrives?

Visitor and problem

Who arrives? What do they want or bring?

Useful dialogue

Write two lines that reveal information or a decision.

Action afterwards

What changes because of what was said?

Ending

How does the problem resolve?

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Write your draft | Use your plan

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Your turn

Write The Unexpected Visitor for classmates. Use a short conversation that changes what a character knows or does. Finish the story; do not write only a conversation.
Useful words: knocked, replied, pocket, discovered. Choose only words that fit.

My writing

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Edit and improve | Show what changed

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Read your draft aloud

[ ] My visitor has a purpose.
[ ] My dialogue reveals information or a decision.
[ ] An action follows the conversation.
[ ] Quotation marks show spoken words and speakers are clear.

One focused improvement

Before: “Hello,” she said.
After: “Your team left this map at the gate,” she said.
Make one spoken line reveal information that affects the next action.

My before-and-after revision

Original sentence(s):

Improved version:

Explain your change

My change helps the reader because _____

Final writing check

[ ] I checked capitals, punctuation and spelling.
[ ] I read my work to check meaning.
[ ] I can explain one useful improvement.

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Teacher and parent guide | Teaching support

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Teaching sequence

Read and discuss the model, plan orally, then draft and revise. Split across sessions and adjust to the learner. Year 2 may write a shorter text or draw before drafting. Supply extra paper when needed. Models are examples, not scripts to memorise.

Answers and acceptable alternatives

She found the bag beside the oval gate and mentions a note. Luca asks where she found it. He checks the note and calls the teacher. Dialogue changes what Luca knows and does.
Notice task: B identifies an obstacle and an action. Greetings can belong in a story, but this exchange has a stronger plot function.

Support, challenge and coaching

Support: Act out a two-line exchange, then describe the next action.
Challenge: Include a misunderstanding that dialogue resolves. Start a new paragraph when the speaker changes.
Ask: If you remove this conversation, does the story lose anything?

Observe learning and check transfer

For each page 4 target skill, record Not yet / With support / Independently. Note adult prompting or scribing. Give one next step and let the child revise.
Later task: A Visitor at the Library. Hide the model and check the same skill on a new task. Accept other responses that satisfy the criteria.

Curriculum scope

Supports selected aspects of AC9E4LY06: creating and editing texts appropriate to purpose. This pack focuses on use dialogue to change what happens. It does not cover the whole year-level curriculum.
Reference: Australian Curriculum v9 English; source links in the accompanying audit.

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